



7 CATCHING THE CRETAN BULL

On the island of Crete, King Minos kept a ferocious fire-breathing bull that he had stolen from Poseidon. On the orders of Eurystheus, Heracles went to steal the beast from Minos himself. Heracles had to fight the terrifying bull, only narrowly escaping its sharp horns and kicking hooves, but he managed to capture it. He took it to Eurystheus who, once he had laid eyes on the bull, allowed it to be set free.



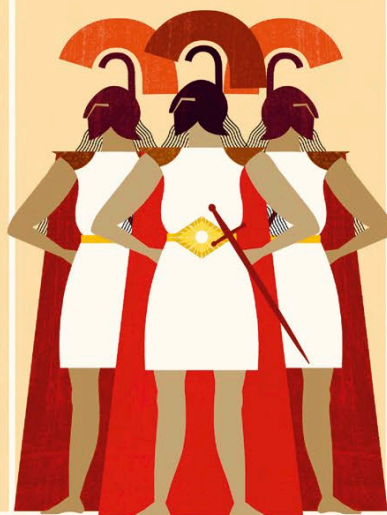
8 STEALING THE MARES OF DIOMEDES

Heracles' eighth challenge was to take the horses of Diomedes, son of Ares. These were no ordinary horses, though—they ate people alive. With a team of two others, Heracles was able to wrestle the horses from their stables. Diomedes saw that they were gone, however, and chased Heracles. The two men fought and Diomedes was killed. Heracles returned triumphant to Eurystheus's palace.



9 TAKING HIPPOLYTA'S BELT

The Amazons were a group of mighty female warriors. Eurystheus sent Heracles to steal the belt of the Amazon queen, Hippolyta, but she liked Heracles and agreed to give it to him. Hera was furious at this and disguised herself as Hippolyta to trick the rest of the Amazons into attacking Heracles. Heracles believed that Hippolyta had betrayed him and killed her before fleeing with the belt.



10 STEALING THE CATTLE OF GERYON

The tenth labor was to steal the cattle of Geryon, a giant with the body of three men attached at the waist. When Heracles landed on Geryon's island, he began to herd the cattle away, but he was attacked by the giant's dog, Orthrus. He killed the hound, but the noise alerted Geryon. They fought, and Heracles killed Geryon by shooting one of his heads with an arrow. He then sailed away with the cattle.



... but Heracles completed the next eight labors easily. Eurystheus was more determined than ever to make him fail.